



What is India's eSports future like?

EsportsXO's CEO and Co-Founder, Vikas Goel sheds light on India's esports future and the role of their platform in its development

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We had the opportunity to converse with Mr Vikas Goel, Co-Founder, EsportsXO, who shed some light on the SaaS platform. EsportsXO is a platform that connects brands to upcoming content creators and aspiring gamers. Here's what he had to say –

Q Can you tell us a bit about ESportsXO? What exactly is EsportsXO?

A So the idea of ESportsXO was conceived in somewhere in April 2020. I'll give you the background of the other two founders. When both of these guys are very young, I met them during a conference. And these guys were doing some fun and exciting stuff in dropshipping, which was very big thing in 2020. A lot of people were making a lot of money in Shopify stores, so I got naturally attracted to the idea and I told them, 'Okay, I'll put in some money'. You guys handle the store, I know how to the products. So we started a store in January. It ran into trouble in April because the supplies ran out and we could not ship products from Shanghai to us.

That's when they told me, Okay, there is a game PUBG and a lot of people are playing and you can talk, you can, you know, watch, you can obviously share screen. So I played this just for fun for a few days, and I understood that this market is very fragmented, and we decided to okay, let's launch our own app within the first 16 days.

And we decided, okay, to organize these tournaments, which are otherwise being organized on WhatsApp and Discord. In the first three and a half months, we got over 1,40,000 installs without having spent a single penny on Facebook and Google advertising. And that's when we realized, okay, this idea is too big. We need to register a company, and put in some more money. And by the time we could do that, by October, the game got banned. So we pivoted out and the story quite unfolded. You know, we got into other stuff, we did some agency work, we spoke with a lot of players, we built our own teams, and then, you know, we decided to scrap up the old tech and started working on the new tech. We realized that this idea is so big that I cannot support it individually. So I decided to raise money. And that was another journey. We never raised money. I've always ran profitable companies before. So we learned how to work this out. We found a circle, found us, and they led that round, and we raised about \$1.1 million in December 2021.

Q How exactly does this system benefit, an up and coming gamer or a new gamer who's looking to go pro?

A If you, if you continue to play, if you explore this opportunity of coming and playing tournaments, getting ranked and creating enough, continue to get notice, you have an option to make money, you have an option to,

you know, become a professional gamer. You also have an option to, if you're not playing actively, if you're not a gamer, you can still make your career in casting, you can still be a technician. There are hundreds of roles out there, which nobody knows, which, which we can probably give you access to. So this is how, you know, a gamer's journey is. They never become famous on day one.

Now, let's say, I'm a gamer. I want to stream and I want to make billions of dollars. No, you have to start by playing games first. You need to download and find a game that you can play good and become, excellent across maybe three to four months, five months, six months down the line. Once you do that, once you have built that repetition within the Indian gaming scene by constantly performing in a particular game, you get noticed this is how models and scouts were built, right? They got to noticed only when they performed in domestic, international, and other podium finishes. They got noticed by brands. That's how they get invitation from domestic and international competitions. So we've understood that journey very clearly.

We are tracking their behavior, we are building our own data links. So the whole journey from no one to becoming a professional gamer, there are a lot of stuff and we are trying to solve that problem using the tech on battle-exo.com, which is the product that we built. *